

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

Media Arts and Design (BA) with Critical Media Studies Concentration

This Concentration provides a thorough grounding in thinking critically, analytically, and creatively about media, their use, and their historical development. CMS Concentration students have the opportunity to perform critical media research and engage in the critical creative production of media. The CMS Concentration examines the ethical and social dimensions of media and applies that knowledge in the creation and analysis of digital media texts. By selecting courses from a variety of School elective headings, students are able to infuse other areas of interest into their focus on Critical Media Studies.

Unless otherwise noted, courses in Media Arts and Design are open to all students in the University. However, students majoring in Media Arts and Design may be given preference in certain course enrollments.

Major Honors

MAD seniors in the CMS concentration who have completed at least 30 graded upper-division semester credit hours and have a major GPA of 3.67 may elect to participate in Major Honors. These students can either complete a thesis or project under the supervision of an AHT faculty member and a second reader, or enroll in an advanced lab or topics course and complete a thesis related to the course content under the supervision of an AHT faculty member.

Students should consult their AHT academic advisor for further details.

Bachelor of Arts in Media Arts and Design with Critical Media Studies Concentration

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Anne Balsamo

Associate Professors: Heidi Cooley, Hong An Wu

Associate Professors of Instruction: Laura Imaoka

Assistant Professors of Instruction: James Fraley, Audra Heaslip

UT Dallas Affiliated Faculty: Christina Nielsen, Christine Veras

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[MATH 1306](#) College Algebra for the Non-Scientist

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses

II. Major Requirements, Lower-Division: 25 semester credit hours

[AHTC 1100](#) First Year Seminar

Foundations

[ATCM 2300](#) Introduction to TechnoCulture

[ATCM 2301](#) Digital Art and Design Foundations

[ATCM 2302](#) Design I

[ATCM 2335](#) Internet Studio I

Fundamentals

[ATCM 2320](#) Introduction to Media Research

[ATCM 2330](#) Digital Art and Social Practice

Choose two from:

[ATCM 2321](#) Reading Media Critically

[ATCM 2322](#) Media Histories

[ATCM 2325](#) Introduction to Ethnic Studies

III. Major Requirements, Upper-Division: 24 semester credit hours

[ATCM 3320](#) Critical Media Theories

[ATCM 3321](#) Networked Identities

[ATCM 3325](#) Global Media Cultures

[ATCM 3331](#) Critical Making

[ATCM 4320](#) Political Economy of Digital Media

[ATCM 4326](#) Multimedia Storytelling

[ATCM 4330](#) Culture Jamming

Choose one of the following during either of your last two semesters:

[ATCM 4332](#) Critical Media Studies Lab I¹

[ATCM 4333](#) Critical Media Studies Lab II¹

[ATCM 4334](#) Topics in Critical Media Studies¹

[ATCM 4399](#) Senior Honors in Media Arts and Design

IV. Elective Requirements: 29 semester credit hours

Prescribed Electives: 15 semester credit hours

Choose any five courses from the following: (At least 2 must be 4000 level)

[ANGM 3315](#) Animation Studies

[ATCM 3323](#) Reading in a Networked Era

[ATCM 3388](#) Social Influence and Persuasive Design

[ANGM 3366](#) Game Studies I

[ATCM 4322](#) Disability, Technology, and Media

[ATCM 4323](#) Feminism, Technology, and Media

[ATCM 4325](#) Race, Technology, and Media

[ATCM 4327](#) Privacy and Surveillance

[ATCM 4332](#) Critical Media Studies Lab I

[ATCM 4333](#) Critical Media Studies Lab II

[ATCM 4334](#) Topics in Critical Media Studies

[ANGM 4366](#) Game Studies II

[ATCM 4384](#) Ethics in New Media, Technology, and Communication

[FILM 2332](#) Understanding Film

[FILM 3321](#) Film in Historical Context

[FILM 3325](#) Film Authorship

[FILM 3342](#) Topics in Film

Free Electives: 14 semester credit hours

Both upper-and lower-division courses may be used as electives.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

1. Students who are eligible for major honors and enroll in one of these options can enroll in ATCM 4099 as a co-requisite to pursue major honors.

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